The Figure 11.42 shows the second mode of vibration in open pipes. It has two nodes and three anti-nodes, and therefore,

$$L = \lambda_2 \text{ or } \lambda_2 = L$$

The frequency

$$f_2 = \frac{v}{\lambda_2} = \frac{v}{L} = 2 \times \frac{v}{2L} = 2 f_1$$

is called ***first over tone***. Since $n = 2$ here, it is called the ***second harmonic***.

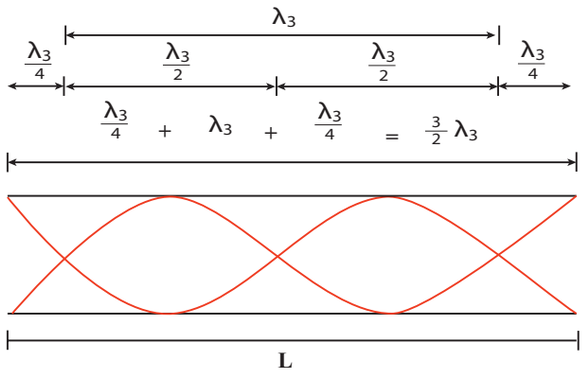


Figure 11.43 Third mode of vibration having three nodes and four anti-nodes

The Figure 11.43 above shows the third mode of vibration having three nodes and four anti-nodes

$$L = \frac{3}{2} \lambda_3 \text{ or } \lambda_3 = \frac{2L}{3}$$

The frequency

$$f_3 = \frac{v}{\lambda_3} = \frac{3v}{2L} = 3 f_1$$

is called *second over tone*. Since $n = 3$ here, it is called the *third harmonic*.

Hence, the open organ pipe has all the harmonics and frequency of nth harmonic is $f_n = nf_1$. Therefore, the frequencies of harmonics are in the ratio

$$f_1 : f_2 : f_3 : f_4 : \ldots = 1 : 2 : 3 : 4 : \ldots \quad (11.79)$$

EXAMPLE 11.25

If a flute sounds a note with 450*Hz*, what are the frequencies of the second, third, and fourth harmonics of this pitch?. If the clarinet sounds with a same note as 450*Hz*, then what are the frequencies of the lowest three harmonics produced ?.

Solution

For a flute which is an open pipe, we have

Second harmonics $f_2 = 2 f_1 = 900$ Hz

Third harmonics $f_3 = 3 f_1 = 1350$ Hz

Fourth harmonics $f_4 = 4 f_1 = 1800$ Hz

For a clarinet which is a closed pipe, we have

Second harmonics $f_2 = 3 f_1 = 1350$ Hz

Third harmonics $f_3 = 5 f_1 = 2250$ Hz

Fourth harmonics $f_4 = 7 f_1 = 3150$ Hz

EXAMPLE 11.26

If the third harmonics of a closed organ pipe is equal to the fundamental frequency of an open organ pipe, compute the length of the open organ pipe if the length of the closed organ pipe is 30 cm.

Solution

Let l_2 be the length of the open organ pipe, with $l_1 = 30\,cm$ the length of the closed organ pipe.

It is given that the third harmonic of closed organ pipe is equal to the fundamental frequency of open organ pipe.

The third harmonic of a closed organ pipe is

$$f_2 = \frac{v}{\lambda_2} = \frac{3v}{4l_1} = 3 f_1$$

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